

Fearnleys Dry Bulk Weekly

Apr 15, 2026





Capesize/Newcastlemax

Fundamental data in China has continued to improve over the last week, likely meaning the market will be well supported. However, a swing down is indicated by a relatively less tight South Atlantic market and a high laden/ballast ratio.

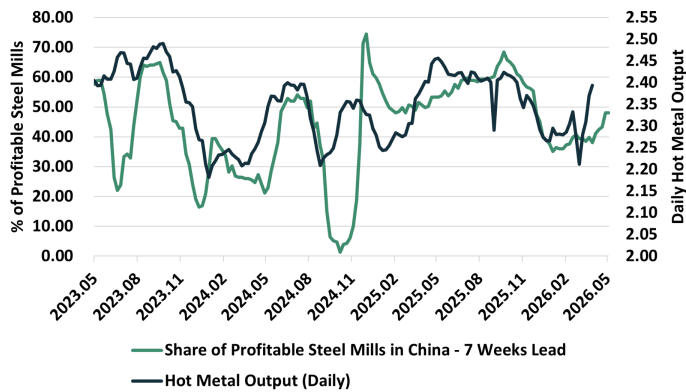
Top left chart: Blast furnace output kept rising last week. The year-on-year change is 0%, so no change in China's underlying demand over the last year. Iron ore inventories have increased by about 40 million tons since July last year, and are now at levels comparable to the peak in 2021.

Top right chart: Shipment volumes were 7.8% higher than last year through week 15.

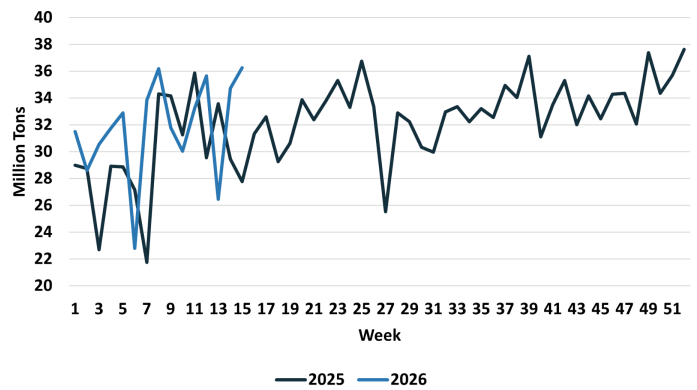
Bottom left chart: The South Atlantic tightness indicator remains low, suggesting a spot market peak is near.

Bottom right chart: VLOC congestion in Brazil has decreased in the last week, and no longer gives a strong bullish indication.

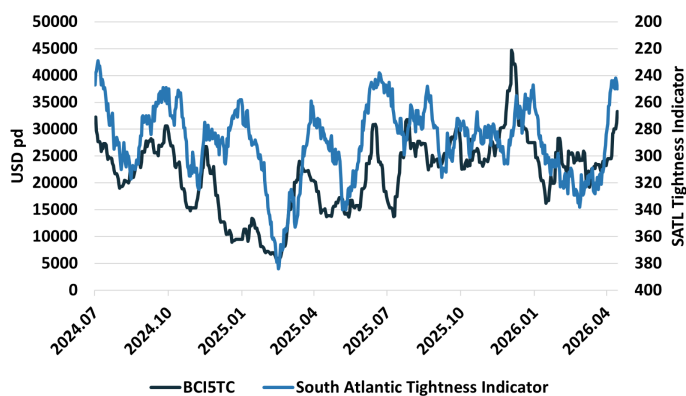
China - Hot Metal Output vs Share of Profitable Steel Mills (7 Weeks Lead)



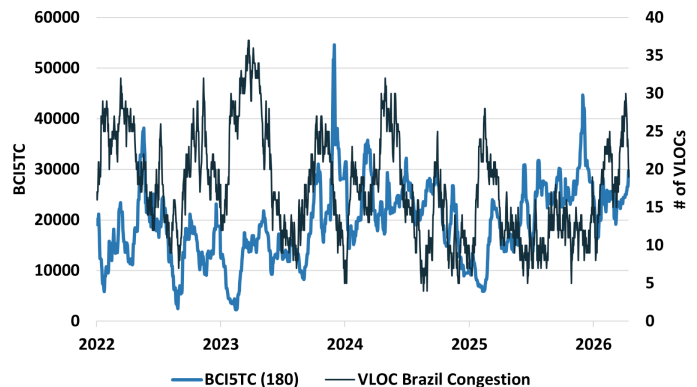
Weekly Shipment Volumes



C5TC 180 vs South Atlantic Tightness Indicator



VLOC Brazil Congestion vs BCI5TC (180)



Panamax/Kamsarmax

As suggested last week, the downtrend that began in early March was over. None of the indicators below suggests any clear direction in the near term.

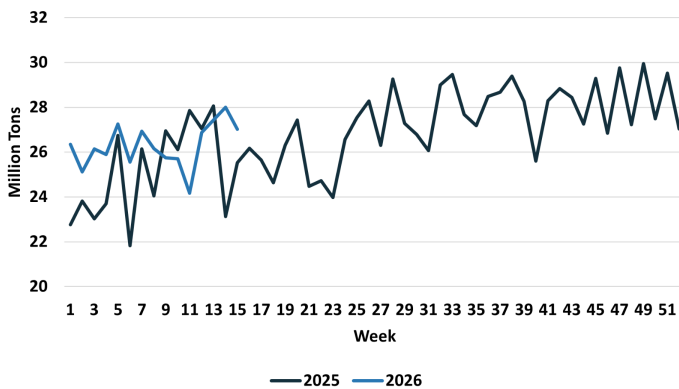
Top left chart: Shipment volumes were up 4.8% year on year through week 15.

Top right chart: Global coal price benchmarks have kept falling over the last week, and futures curves remain in contango. Indonesian benchmark prices were marked higher for the second half of this month, however.

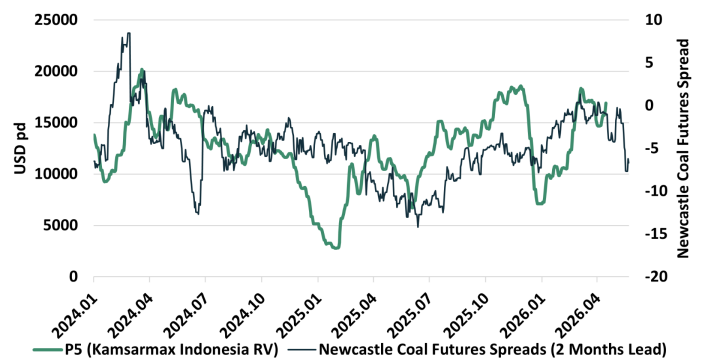
Bottom left chart: The Pacific tightness indicator is unchanged since last week, thus giving no clear direction-wise indication for the market.

Bottom right chart: The SATL tightness indicator is unchanged since last week.

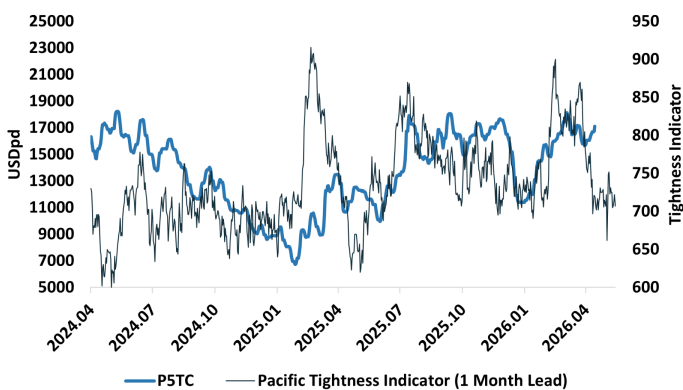
Weekly Shipment Volumes



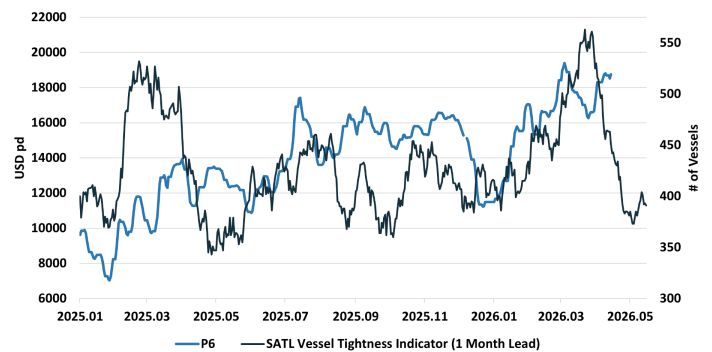
P5 vs Newcastle Coal Futures Curve Spread (Lead 2 Months)



P5TC vs Pacific Vessel Tightness Indicator (Lead 1 Month)



P6 vs South Atlantic Vessel Tightness Indicator (Lead 1 Month)



Supramax/Ultramax

Since last week, the laden/ballast ratio has increased, reflecting a slight worsening of fundamentals. Industrial metals prices have increased sharply in the last few weeks, suggesting these markets are pricing little to no disruption to global manufacturing activity despite the war in Iran. The latter suggests the market will remain stable around current levels in the next couple of months.

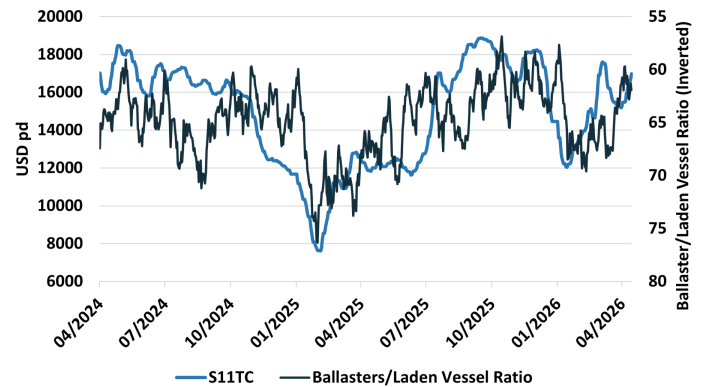
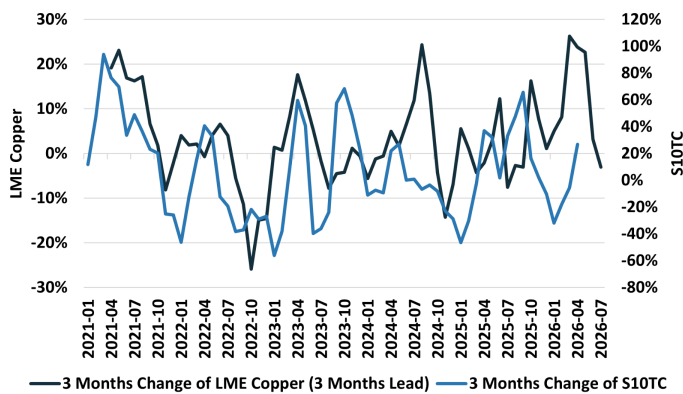
Top left chart: The three-month change in the price of copper has fallen noticeably. Usually, there is a lag of a few months before the same development is seen in the Supramax/Ultramax market. The correlation is still not suggesting the market will fall significantly, but rather that the upside is limited going forward.

Top right chart: The chart compares the ballaster/laden vessel ratio against the S11TC index. A low ballaster/laden vessel ratio reflects a tighter market balance.

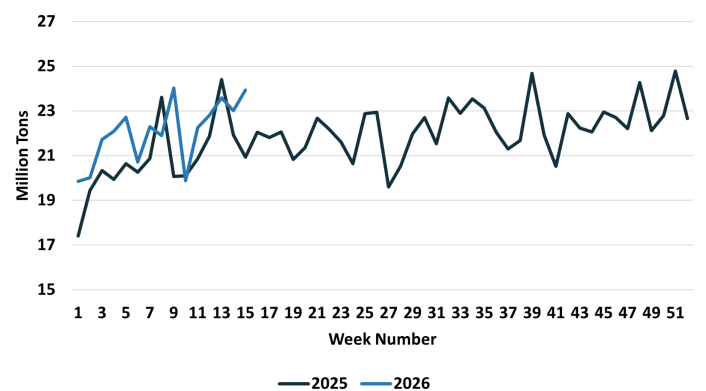
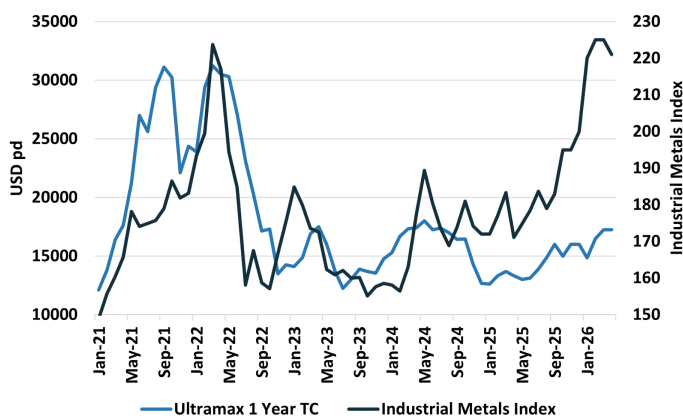
Bottom left chart: Industrial metals prices have rebounded sharply in the last month, suggesting 1-year TC rates will be stable around current levels in the coming months.

Bottom right chart: Shipment volumes were up 5.8% year on year through week 15.

Copper Price 3 Months Change, 3 Months Lead S11TC vs Ballaster/Laden Vessel Ratio vs 3 Months Change of Supra 10TC



Industrial Metals Index vs Ultramax 1 Year TC Weekly Shipment Volumes





Handysize

Most likely, the market will continue trending upwards, following the push in the Ultramax market. The HS7TC index could climb to around 15kpd basis the laden/ballast ratio and the usual ratio to the Ultramax index.

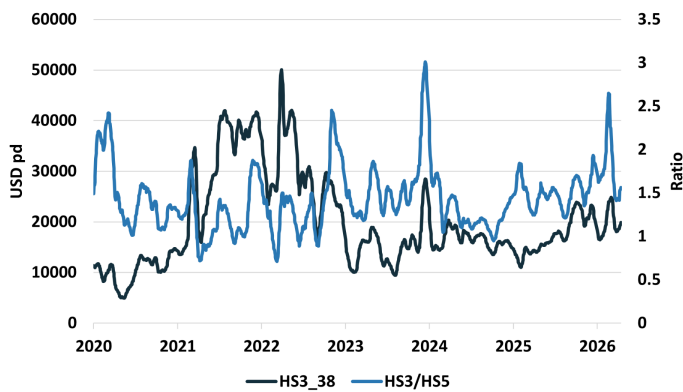
Top left chart: The ratio between Rio-Recalada / Skaw-Passero (HS3) and SEA / Singapore-Japan (HS5) is usually a good predictor of tops and bottoms of the HS3 route. A higher ratio suggests a market top, and a lower ratio suggests a market bottom.

Top right chart: Through week 15, Handysize shipment volumes were 4.8% higher than the same period in 2025.

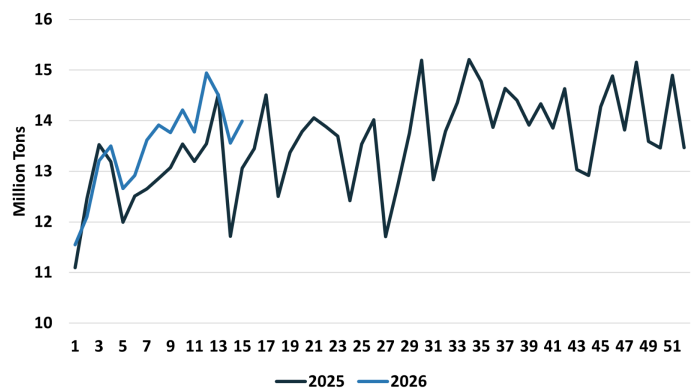
Bottom left chart: The correlation between the S11TC and HS7TC is over 90%. The correlation is even higher when the S11TC index is shifted forward a few days, which means that movements in the S11TC index often lead the movements of the HS7TC.

Bottom right chart: The laden/ballast ratio is an accurate measure of underlying fundamentals, shown by the high correlation it has with to HS7TC index.

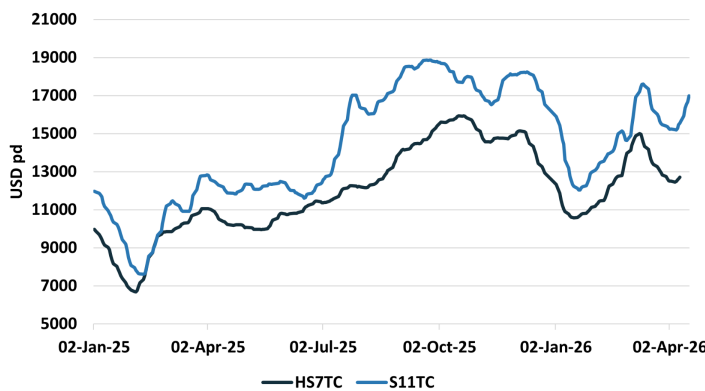
HS3 vs Ratio of HS3 and HS5



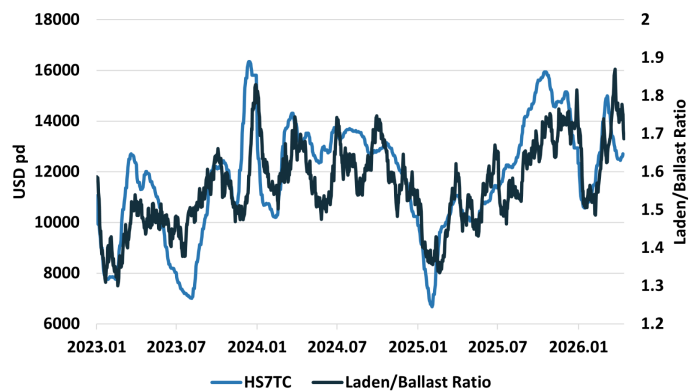
Weekly Shipment Volumes



S11TC Shifted 1 Week Forward, vs HS7TC



Handysize 7TC vs Laden/Ballast Ratio





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